Oregon Department of Human Services

Licensed Child Caring Agency Unannounced Site Visit Report
Residential Care

Licensee: Program Design Concepts, dba New Leaf Academy
Executive Director: Deveney Marshall
Board Chairperson: Craig Christiansen
Date of Unannounced: May 22, 2023
Licensing Coordinator: Robin DuVal

Other Regulatory or Accrediting Agencies: COGNIA accredited, Student Exchange and Visitor Program (SEVS) approved, certified by California Dept. of Education to provide special education services.

Purpose: Per OAR 419-400-0240 (1)(b) Children's Care Licensing is required to perform at least one unannounced site visit a year where children in care reside.

Previous Findings **Unannounced Site Visit 10-13-2022**	**Repeat Findings Further Action Needed**	**Comments**
Case Management 413-215-0681(3)(f) Incident Reporting Incident Reports were filed separately from each youths file. The agency shall ensure Incident Reports must be individualized by each youth and retained in each youth file. 1)Incident reports were individualized by youth when an incident involved more than one youth. No further corrective action needed. 2)Incident reports were filed together, and not in each youth's file. The agency shall provide a systematic procedure to prevent recurrences. **This is a repeat finding.**	**Yes☐ No✓**	The agency recently changed to an electronic system for Incident Report documentation which allows individual documentation and tracking per youth. • This licensor will provide technical assistance to ensure all incident reporting documentation requirements in this new electronic system are being met.

New Findings from Site Visit	Corrective Action
OAR 419-470-0020(2)(c) All areas of buildings where children in care are present must be kept clean and in good repair. OAR 419-470-0020(2)(h)(A) Buildings must be ventilated by natural or mechanical means and must be free of excessive heat, condensation, and obnoxious odors. The following was observed during the walk-thru. • The concrete near the front door is cracked and raised exposing sharp areas creating a trip/fall hazard. • The downstairs bathroom ceiling and wall had black substance, possibly be mold, which is also a health concern. • The downstairs bathroom ventilation fan cover has build-up, which could impact the effectiveness of ventilation from showers.	**Corrective Action:** The agency shall ensure these areas are corrected and institute a prevention method to reduce future occurrences.

Interview Summary
Three youth were individually interviewed, ages 14, 15, and 13, ranging from 3-13 months in the program. They described how the program is helping them. All reported the food is amazing since the new chef started December 2022, they're well fed, and the chef works closely with the nutritionist. They reported getting their medications as prescribed, the therapists are great, and there's staff that are trusting. Family contact is better with therapy and when it's mediated, and they have regular contact in therapy sessions, private calls, and in-person. School is reported as good, and they get help when needed, but one youth reports not liking the change to "online" version of school. With the lower census, it's been good to form closer relationships with peers, but it's also challenging to be with the same group every day. There's some drama among peers and can feel toxic at times. Staff try to redirect, but some insert their personal opinions, side with one youth over another, or let it slide. If a youth gets in trouble, they report there's different levels of consequences such as therapeutic focus paperwork or restrictions ranging from no TV or movie time, not going to the store or an outing, or restriction from interacting with another peer (like time out from peer to peer). One youth described the process when/if a youth is on safety.* On-site activities and outings were described, however a desire was expressed for more or different outings.** They report the agency does well at implementing natural consequences, works well with families, personal development, building family relationship, and having great therapists. The agency could improve on reducing the amount of down time in the evenings, which was referred to as "My Time"*** and described as sitting in the living room with staff present for "silent" time, not able to speak to other peers while doing quiet activities. When asked if they could change anything, it was reported the desire to reduce and/or change "My Time", improve staff's abilities on dealing with youth and peer-to-peer behaviors, and to integrate technology for skill-building to prepare for the "real world" and create opportunities for work or volunteering. <u>This licensor followed up on the below areas:</u> *Further information obtained regarding a youth on "safety" to confirm it meets current licensing rule requirements. **The activity schedule for April, May, and June was provided to this licensor demonstrating regular activities and outing opportunities. ***My Time. The Program Director shared that youth concerns were expressed over a month ago and with youth input, changes were implemented approximately mid-April and documentation of this was provided.

Other notable info: In addition to the full-time RN during the week, a new LPN nurse was recently hired for weekend coverage.

Observations
The Executive Director accompanied this licensor for the walk-thru which consisted of the dorm rooms, bedrooms, living rooms, medication room, dining hall, kitchen, and therapists' office area. The environment was welcoming, in good condition and clean, except areas noted above. Food was observed in the various refrigerators, freezers, and pantry. Bedrooms and dorm rooms were relatively clean with beds made and had individualized décor.

Corrective Actions and Timeframes: Please submit the following to verify compliance.

Within 45 days of receipt of this report, New Leaf Academy must submit a letter of verification indicating the agency is in compliance with the specific rules cited above and describing how compliance will be maintained going forward. Along with the letter of verification, the agency must submit any and all specific documentation requested in the body of this report. The letter of verification and any additional requested documents can be emailed directly to **robin.m.duval@odhsoha.oregon.gov**.

Licensing Coordinator's Signature: _____ Date: 6/2/2023

Manager Review: _____ Date: 6-2-2023